[Metric]
A-A-427C
April 12, 1996
Superseding
A-A-427B
September 29, 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
SHARPENER, PENCIL (AND C- CLAMP)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers two types of pencil sharpeners for heavy duty office use.

2. **Classification:**

Type:	I. - Draftsman
	II. - General Writing

3. **Salient Characteristics:**

3.1 **Materials**. Sharpeners shall be of a material suitable for the above type of sharpeners. Exposed metal surfaces shall be nickel plated or made corrosion resistant by a suitable finish.

3.2 **Construction:**

3.2.1 **Crank handles**. Crank handles shall be made of a suitable metal and shall be finished with a plastic knob. Both the handle and the knob shall turn freely.

3.2.2 **Receptacle**. Receptacle shall be metal, plastic or a combination of metal and plastic and shall be removable but shall be firmly in place during use by means of a locking device.

3.2.3 **Cutters**. Each sharpener shall be provided with a set of replaceable cutters. A set shall consist of two cutters which shall be readily removed without the use of special tools. The cutters shall be fabricated out of metal commonly used by the industry for the purpose intended and shall be heat treated for durability.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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3.2.4 **Mounting.** The base shall be provided with a minimum of three screws holes and three screws. The base shall be flat over not less than two-thirds its area, so that the sharpener can be mounted on a desk or table top by means of a C- clamp.

3.2.5 **Aperture Plate.** Sharpeners shall be furnished with a variable aperture plate. The openings shall be regulated by means of a perforated rotating disk or a sliding or hinged perforated plate which shall be equipped with a locking device to hold the disk firmly in place with each change in aperture. Sharpeners shall accommodate pencils from .635 cm to 1.111 cm (.250 inches to .4375 inches) in diameter. Aperture plate shall have a minimum of six openings.

3.2.6 **C-Clamp & Base.** The C-clamp and base shall be made of cold-rolled steel with a Rockwell B hardness of 70 ± 10 and shall be finished in accordance with standard commercial practice. The clamp shall be .238 cm (.093 inches) thick, 5.318 cm ± .317 cm (2.093 inches) ± .125 inches) long, 2.778 cm (1-3/8 inches) wide and have a throat depth of 3.175 cm ± 6.35 cm(1-1/4 inches ± 1/4 inches). The threaded thumbscrew or eye bolt screw shall be 5.318 cm ± .317 cm (2-3/8 inches ± 1/8 inches) long with a foot attached. The foot shall not be less than 1.27 cm ± .158 cm (1/2 inches) ± 1/16 inches) in diameter. The C-clamp shall have a minimum opening of 5 cm (1.97 inches).

3.3 **Identification Marking.** Each sharpener shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark in accordance with standard commercial practice.

3.4 **Workmanship.** The sharpener and parts shall be well made, smoothly finished and all moving parts shall function satisfactorily. The sharpener shall have no defects that affect serviceability or appearance.

4. **Regulatory Requirement:** The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practical, in accordance with Paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4.1 **Certification.** The contractor shall certify that if polystyrene is used in the manufacture of the item, it shall contain a minimum of 25 percent Postconsumer Recovered Materials in accordance with the 40 Code of Federal Regulations Part 247, Comprehensive Guideline for Procurement of Products Containing Recovered Materials; final rule. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provision of the contract.

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5. Quality Assurance Requirement:

5.1 **Product Conformance.** The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 **Examination & Testing.**

5.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

5.2.2 End item inspection may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. While in process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing they may be used for visual and dimensional inspections sampling.

5.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection shall be required The sample unit shall be one sharpener Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

5.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual and dimensional examination shall be S-3 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above

6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

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7. **Notes:**

7.1 **Source of Documents:** The issue of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description. Purchasers shall specify the following in the contract or purchase order.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2, Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

7.1.3 Title 40, Code of Federal Regulations, Protection of Environment, Part 247 copies may be obtained from the U.S. Government Printing Office Washington, DC 20402, phone (202) 783-3238.

7.2 **National Stock Number Listing (NSN).** The following is a list of NSN's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible NSN's associated with the CID.

7520-00-162-6178
7520-00-224-7593

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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